

WRH Sample Session Page

Session 16 — The Alarm

What Really Happened™ | Survival Map Sample

Session Purpose

This session teaches participants how the nervous system can begin reacting before the thinking brain has fully understood what is happening.

WRH calls this stage **The Alarm**.

The Alarm is not weakness.
It is not attitude.
It is not defiance.
It is not a character flaw.

The Alarm is the body's threat-detection system turning on.

Sometimes the danger is real.
Sometimes the danger is old.
Sometimes the danger is over.
But the body does not always know the difference yet.

Core Teaching Point

Before a person makes a choice, the body may already be preparing to survive.

That preparation can look like:

- shutting down
- getting angry fast
- leaving the room
- refusing to talk
- laughing at the wrong time
- going blank
- using substances
- avoiding calls or appointments
- saying "I don't care" when they actually feel overwhelmed

In many systems, these responses get labeled as noncompliance.

WRH teaches a different question:

What alarm went off before the behavior showed up?

Facilitator Language

Use plain language.

Do not ask participants to disclose trauma stories.

Do not ask, "What happened to you?"

Ask:

"What does your Alarm look like?"

Examples:

- "Some people get loud."
- "Some people get quiet."
- "Some people leave."
- "Some people freeze."
- "Some people joke."
- "Some people agree to everything and then disappear."
- "Some people feel trapped before anyone else can tell."

The goal is not confession.

The goal is recognition.

The WRH Reframe

Most people are judged after the Alarm has already turned into behavior.

WRH slows the sequence down.

Instead of:

"Why did you act like that?"

WRH asks:

"What did your system think it had to protect you from?"

This does not excuse harm.

It creates a place to interrupt the pattern earlier next time.

Mini Teaching Example

A participant misses three appointments.

A standard system may say:

"He is not serious."

"She does not care."

"They are refusing help."

WRH asks:

"What happened before the missed appointment?"

Possible Alarm points:

- The phone rang and the body froze.
- The appointment felt like judgment.
- Transportation felt impossible.
- Shame made the person avoid the building.
- The person expected to be talked down to.
- The reminder message triggered panic instead of planning.

The missed appointment is the visible behavior.

The Alarm is what happened underneath it.

Participant Reflection

Invite participants to choose one sentence stem.

They do not have to share out loud.

When my Alarm turns on, I usually...

People think I am being difficult when I am actually...

One early sign that my Alarm is active is...

One safer interrupt I could try before the pattern finishes is...

Directional-Change Link

This is where the Survival Map connects to the Trajectory Engine.

The Alarm shows where the pattern begins to activate.

The Trajectory Engine asks:

Where is the fork?

A fork may be small:

- pausing before leaving
- asking for five minutes
- sending one text instead of disappearing
- naming "I'm activated"
- stepping outside without abandoning the whole situation
- using a written plan instead of trying to explain under pressure

Small interrupts matter because the nervous system learns through repeated evidence.

Closing Line

The Alarm is not the enemy.

The Alarm is a signal.

WRH helps people learn the signal earlier, name it without shame, and practice a safer next move before the old pattern finishes.

Scope Note: WRH is non-clinical educational material. It is not therapy, diagnosis, medical advice, clinical care, or crisis response.